

Team First

The step from 'I' to 'we' is the hardest in sport. Players explore what it really means to put the team first, even when it costs something.

⌚ 40 minutes

👥 Group + individual

3 exercises

Evidence-based



What will you take with you today?

01

You can explain what **psychological safety** is and why it affects performance.

02

You actively contribute to a **safe team climate** by asking for help and recognising others.

03

You help close a **shared team contract** that guides the season.

Frazier et al. (2017) — meta-analysis of 136 samples: teams with high psychological safety perform significantly better on creativity and learning behaviour. Effect larger in youth. *Personnel Psychology*, 70(1), 113–165.

Fransen et al. (2015) — season study of 23 basketball teams: a strong 'we' culture shows higher performance stability and lower dropout. *Journal of Sport Sciences*.

Edmondson (1999) — teams that dare to ask for help learn faster and perform better long term than teams that hide mistakes.

Invisible Contribution

Write down a teammate's name and what they did during the last match or training that went unnoticed.

At month's end, read the notes aloud to the group (decide together: anonymous or with names).

This changes how players see each other. Publicly reward behaviour that shows 'team first' — with recognition, not points.



Help Logbook

Actively ask a teammate for help at least 3x during training this month

WHAT & WHAT CAME OF IT

Each time note: what did you ask, and what came of it? Asking for help is not weakness but a sign of trust.

PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY

Teams that dare to show mistakes and ask for help learn faster. You set the example by asking for help yourself.

Build safety: name your own mistakes as coach. 'I made a mistake yesterday. Here's what I learn from it.' This gives players permission.



**"Talent wins games, but
teamwork and intelligence
win championships. The
most important thing in
basketball is trust. Trust your
teammates."**

Michael Jordan — 6x NBA Champion

Tips for this session



Tip 1 — Read aloud

Read the Invisible Contributions aloud to the group. This changes how players see each other.



Tip 2 — Recognise publicly

Reward 'team first' behaviour with recognition, not points: 'What Jonas did, that's team first.' Seen behaviour repeats.



Tip 3 — Name mistakes

Build psychological safety by naming your own mistakes as coach. This gives players permission to be vulnerable.



Careful: playing time

Competitive players with little playing time may struggle with 'team first'. Use this for an individual talk, not group discussion.

40-minute session

5' Write Team Contract individually
min

5' Signing and closing
min

5' Explain Invisible Contribution task

MONTH 5 OF 8 · TEAM FIRST

Stronger together.

Today you took the step from 'I' to 'we' — the hardest and most beautiful step in sport.

⚡ TEAM RITUAL · THE COMPASS WORD

The Compass Word

Each player chooses one value or word they want to live more next week and says it out loud in the circle. Start yourself. One word per player — the power is in the simplicity.

NEXT MONTH → RESILIENCE & GROWTH MINDSET

Ask players to write down one setback this month and what they learned from it. Next month: Resilience & Growth Mindset.